



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Holy Family Academy

School Website: <https://holyfamily.redeemer.ab.ca/>

December 27, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Holy Family Academy (Brooks, Alberta, CTR Catholic) presents a clearly Catholic, faith-centered learning community with strong parish-school ties and explicit faith permeation across its curriculum and daily life. The school's materials emphasize Catholic identity, liturgical life (Mass and Catholic celebrations), and faith formation as foundational to education. Those features align with a religiously grounded, formation-focused approach, and the school demonstrates explicit efforts to involve families and parish structures in student formation. Consequently, Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) and Element 5 (Faculty) and Element 6 (Parents & Community) register as CLASSICAL. Element 2 (School Purpose and Goal), Element 3 (Curriculum), and Element 4 (Pedagogy) show substantial classical signals (formation, virtue formation, permeation, and liturgical life) but lack explicit Great Books/Trivium-Quadrivium framing or Socratic pedagogy in public-facing materials, placing those categories in the realm of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than full CLASSICAL. Taken together, the aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL, driven by a robust religious-metaphysical foundation, formation-oriented goals, and a living, virtue-oriented faculty and community culture anchored in Catholic education.

Key signals from the two vector stores: - Strong Catholic identity, sacramental life, and permeation of faith across subjects (Catholic world view, liturgy, Mass; growing faith formation through formal programs) documented in the school's site content and related materials.

- Explicit references to faith-based leadership, staff as part of the living curriculum, and parish-school partnership. - Evidence of parent and community partnerships and a model of faith formation that includes families and parish involvement. - Foundational mentions of formation, virtue, and faith integration appropriate to a classical Christian orientation (supported by ICE/classical-literature sources in the knowledge base).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Note on methodology: For each category, keywords drawn from the public-facing school materials were weighed against the Positive and Negative Keyword Indicators in the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) lexicon (and its formal Positive/Negative keyword lists). The analysis includes explicit textual matches (e.g., references to Mass, permeation, faith formation, Great Commission texts, and family/parish partnerships) and maps them to the classical rubric. Citations point to the relevant source documents in the school crawl and the classical-criteria lexicon.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school is explicitly Catholic, with materials describing Catholic education as central and the CTR Catholic system as the governing framework. Documents discuss faith permeating all subjects, the parish-school partnership, and Catholic identity in schooling. - Liturgical life and sacraments are described (e.g., Going to Mass, school Masses, liturgical celebrations). This demonstrates liturgical and communal practices as integral to education. - Religion programs and faith formation are formal parts of the curriculum (Growing in Faith, Growing in Christ; Go and Make Disciples: Living the Great Commission).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Catholic, Catholic Education, CTR Catholic, Permeation, Mass, liturgy, parish partnerships, faith formation, sacramental. These align with Positive Keyword indicators for Grounded Theology, Liturgical/Communal Practices, and Transcendental Reality. - Negative keywords: None observed in the public-facing materials for this category.

Why this rating - The combination of explicit Catholic identity, permeation of faith across subjects, and a liturgical life embedded in daily school routines meets the core elements of religious-metaphysical foundations (transcendence through faith, liturgical life, and theology-infused curriculum). The presence of Mass and permeation arguments anchors this category as CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Documents emphasize faith formation and alignment with Catholic moral/theological aims, with explicit references to faith formation and virtue as part of the education plan. The ICE material on modeling virtue and formation supports this logic in classical education. - The Education Plan/Results framework emphasizes citizenship, safety, and wellness, and it frames education as formation within a Catholic-identity context rather than purely career-readiness.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, telos, faith formation, moral imagination, affection formation (via Catholic formation and parish involvement). These map to the Positive Keyword indicators for formation and virtue. - Negative keywords: Not evident in the public-facing materials for this category (no explicit emphasis on workforce-preparation language or 21st-century-skills framing in opposition to formation).

Why this rating - The school clearly prioritizes formation and virtue through Catholic formation and religiously anchored goals, but there is less explicit evidence of a Great Conversation, liberal-arts telos, or classic Trivium/Quadrivium framing in the public-facing public materials. This suggests a strong formation orientation, but not the full spectrum of the classical telos as narrowly defined in the Six Essential Elements. Hence, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize religious education and Catholic faith formation, with explicit mention of religion programs and permeation across subjects. There is no explicit documentation of Great Books, Great Conversation, Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), or Quadrivium across the curriculum in the school's site content. The religion-governed program and faith-permeated curriculum are highlighted, not a liberal-arts framework. - When the curriculum is described, it centers on faith formation and Catholic worldview rather than the seven liberal arts or classic canonical texts.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Great Books, primary sources, Trivium/Quadrivium, Latin/Greek, universal classical texts (from the knowledge-base classical lexicon), but not evidenced in the school's own public materials. The public school content does not showcase these liberal-arts elements; instead, it references Catholic-religion pedagogy and permeation. - Negative keywords: The

absence of Great Books/Great Conversation or Trivium/Quadrivium in the school's site content signals a divergence from the classical curriculum lexicon.

Why this rating - The absence of explicit Great Books, liberal-arts curriculum, and classical-tradition pedagogy on the school's public-facing site supports a NOT CLASSICAL category for Curriculum. The school foregrounds Catholic faith formation rather than the traditional classical curriculum.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials emphasize faith permeation, parish-school partnership, and religious formation rather than explicit classical pedagogical methods (e.g., Socratic seminars, memorization, recitation, or Paideia-style discussions). There are references to liturgical practices and faith integration rather than classical pedagogical frameworks. - Some classical pedagogy-related resources exist in the knowledge-base (the Six Essential Elements and associated literature) but are not clearly reflected in Holy Family Academy's public-facing materials as implemented teaching methods (e.g., no explicit mention of Socratic dialogue, recitation/narration, or mastery through imitation in the school's public materials).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: liturgy, reverence, sacred, permeation, catechesis, sacramental imagination, canonical religious texts (in the Catholic context). These align more with religious-cultural pedagogy than with the classical pedagogy lexicon (which emphasizes Socratic dialogue, memorization, and the Trivium/Quadrivium). - Negative keywords present: presence of "Socratic dialogue" and "recitation" are not evidenced in the school's public materials; absence is a negative signal for classical pedagogy.

Why this rating - Despite a strong religious (Catholic) framework, there is a lack of explicit classical teaching methods (Socratic seminars, memorization, chant-based memory work, etc.) in the public materials. Therefore, Pedagogy is NOT CLASSICAL according to the Six Essential Elements rubric as publicly documented for this school.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school materials describe faculty as a living, embodied curriculum with faith leadership, and governance expectations that emphasize Catholic identity and faith leadership (i.e., faith leadership roles, parish ties, and alignment with Canon Law). This reflects a model of virtue, mentorship, and a community of teachers who embody the school's mission. - Specific language about faith leadership, faith committee, and parish integration indicates teachers are expected to model virtue and participate in the school's faith life, aligning with the "living curriculum" and "portrait of teacher" concepts in the classical lexicon. - Parent and community engagement is framed as part of the broader community-building and formation process, which is consistent with a classical view of faculty as mentors and guides within a small-faith community.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: teachers as models of virtue, mentorship, living curriculum, faith leadership, collegial culture, priestly/parish collaboration, and faith formation within the faculty. These align with Positive Keywords in the Faculty category. - Negative keywords present: none observed in public materials.

Why this rating - The public communications emphasize faculty as moral exemplars and faith-guided mentors, consistent with CLASSICAL signals for Faculty (positive signals like virtue modeling and living curriculum). The explicit emphasis on faith and formation strengthens the classical orientation in this category.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with families and parish life, with explicit statements about family involvement, catechesis at home, and a three-way partnership with home, school, and parish. It describes faith formation and parental engagement as central, including programs that invite family participation in religious and community life. - Documentation about faith permeation and Catholic worldview shows that parents and community are integral to student formation, not just customers; the materials describe shared mission, faith initiatives, and a welcoming environment for families and parish partners. - The presence of parish-based faith leadership, community events, and family involvement programs aligns with the “partnership with families” and “formation of affections” positive keywords in the classical framework.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent formation, home-school parish partnership, family catechesis, parental involvement, faith life integration, and community engagement. - Negative keywords: None observed in the public materials.

Why this rating - The school's public materials strongly emphasize parent involvement and community-faith partnerships, fulfilling CLASSICAL signals in Parents & Community. The explicit framing of families as co-educators and the parish-school triad aligns with the classical tradition's expectations for community formation and shared mission.

What Would Move the Needle

Note: This section is included only when a school is ranked SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Holy Family Academy is classified as CLASSICAL overall, so no needle-move section is required by the rubric for this institution.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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